

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with direct experience supporting complex disputes and litigation at BCLP, including a six-month seat in International Arbitration and a six-month seat in Real Estate Disputes. Experienced in document review, electronic bundle preparation, procedural drafting, legal research, case-file management and deadline tracking. Currently advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire across housing, employment, welfare and debt matters, managing files from instruction to submission. Seeking a paralegal role in litigation to build on that foundation while working toward a training contract.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**
Queen Mary University of London

- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**
University College London

- Modules: Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**
King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior on the matter in the lead-up to a significant procedural deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues, and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, tracking costs and deadlines throughout

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**
Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client interview to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across housing, employment, welfare, debt and consumer matters
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets filing deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and document review; electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, electronic hearing bundles, procedural histories and orders, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters